even if it succeeded militarily, Pakistan lacked the political and diplomatic resources to achieve broader strategic success.[59]

Like these early plans, Pakistan's actual Kargil operation was designed primarily to threaten India's position in Siachen Glacier. According to Pakistani president Pervez Musharraf, "Kargil was fundamentally about Kashmir," where the Indians occupy Pakistani territory, "for example at Siachen. . . . Emotions run very high here" on this issue. "Siachen is barren wasteland, but it belongs to us."[60] Jalil Jilani, former director general for South Asia in Pakistan's Ministry of Foreign Affairs, describes Siachen as "perhaps the most important factor" underlying the Kargil operation. "Without Siachen," he argues, "Kargil would not have taken place."[61]

Again like the earlier plans, the actual Kargil operation was facilitated by Pakistan's nuclear capacity. But by 1999, thanks to the nuclear tests, the Pakistani capacity was overt. Whereas before skeptics might have questioned Pakistan's nuclear prowess, now no one could doubt it; Pakistan clearly possessed the ability to launch a nuclear retaliation in the event of a large-scale Indian conventional attack. Jilani explains that this overt capability increased Pakistani leaders' willingness to challenge India in Kashmir. In the absence of a clear Pakistani nuclear capacity, Jilani argues, "India wouldn't be restrained" in responding to such provocations. However, an overt Pakistani nuclear capability "brought about deterrence," ensuring that there would be "no major war" between India and Pakistan. In addition, conflict between two openly nuclear states would attract international attention, encouraging outside diplomatic intervention in Kashmir. Thus, as Jilani explained, nuclear weapons played a double role in Pakistani strategy at Kargil. They "deterred India" from all-out conventional retaliation against Pakistan. And they sent a message to the outside world regarding the importance of the Kashmir dispute. "War between nuclear powers is not a picnic. It's a very serious business. . . . One little incident in Kashmir could undermine everything."[62]

Pakistani analysts also note the emboldening impact of an overt nuclear capability on Pakistan's behavior in Kashmir. Shireen Mazari argues that "open testing makes a big difference in the robustness of deterrence," further encouraging the outbreak of limited warfare.